international law. Moreover as Nigel Inkster, a former British spymaster now at a London think-tank, notes:

> it is clear that much of the non-US data searched by the NSA was in fact provided by the intelligence services of the countries concerned, with the authorisation of their governments, as part of a programme of collaboration on counter-terrorism.[10]

For all that, people everywhere need better ways to rebut damaging conclusions that may be drawn from automatic analysis of electronic information. It would not be acceptable if, for example, an innocent non-American landed irrevocably on an international no-fly list, or were deprived of a bank account, just for being a pious Muslim who studies chemistry and likes aeroplanes.[11] Though such worries are widespread, especially about how such capabilities might be abused in future, examples of things actually going wrong right now are remarkably scanty. Snowden has claimed:

> I, sitting at my desk, could wiretap anyone, from you or your accountant to a federal judge or even the president, if I had a personal e-mail.[12]

That is a shocking claim. But it depends heavily on the world 'could'. He 'could' also have set fire to his desk. Neither form of behaviour is condoned by the NSA. Both arson and warrantless wiretaps of random Americans are punishable. With a million-plus stolen documents at their disposal, the worst case involving deliberate intrusion into individual privacy—in America or abroad—that the Snowden camp has been able to come up with so far involves six radical Muslims (one of them with American connections) whose penchant for online pornography and contact with under-age girls had come to the attention of the NSA. The agency appears to have been mulling a leak of this information, as a possible means of